



Security Watch

Adobe Buffer Overflow

The Problem

On August 16, Adobe reported a vulnerability in Reader and Acrobat. The vulnerability is caused due to a 'boundary error' in the core application plug-in, and can be exploited to cause a buffer overflow when a specially-crafted file is opened.

A boundary error happens due to an invalid value entered into an application. For example, if there are too many characters in a text entry, a boundary error occurs.

The Damages

If the vulnerability were successfully exploited, the application could crash, with an increased risk of arbitrary code execution by the hacker.

Precautions

Since the vulnerability is rated as "highly critical", you'll need to update your Adobe software.

For Reader versions 7.0-7.0.2, use the automatic update facility. The 7.0.3 update files can also be manually installed from www.adobe.com/support/downloads. This is the page for all the updates mentioned below.

For Reader versions prior to 7.0, Adobe strongly recommends upgrading to Reader 7.0.3.

For Acrobat versions 7.0-7.0.2, use the automatic update facility. The update files can also be manually installed from the site.

For Acrobat versions 6.0-6.0.3, use the automatic update facility, or install the update from the site. And for Acrobat versions 5.0-5.0.5, download and install the 5.0.10 update from the download site.

indicated it is interested in launching a digital-music service by the end of 2005.

The company had earlier posted a job listing on its Web site for a content acquisition manager for "our forthcoming Digital Music Service." This employee "would seek and license digital-music content worldwide, including content from major recording labels and independent recording labels and artists."

Amazon CEO Jeff Bezos had stated he wanted to increase the digital content offerings on the site. Explaining that the move would bring in larger volumes of traffic to the site, Bezos said that streaming content and video downloads were also being looked into as future options.

With this move, Amazon would join an already crowded but continuously growing segment of online music retailers, led by Apple Computer, Napster and RealNetworks.

CHAMELEON KEYBOARDS

Keyboards To Change Characters For You

Is your 104-key keyboard boring you to death? How about a set of new programmable keyboards? A couple of Russian

companies are working on just that so you don't have to deal with those dreary QWERTY keys any more.

iKeyInfinity, a Moscow-based company, is expected to launch its new multi-language design for the Windows and Macintosh platforms early next year. Connected via a USB 2.0 cable, each key has a 17 x 17 pixel LCD to show the character according to the language used in the operating system.

When the language changes, the image on each key changes accordingly. The company says the image could be any alphabetic letter, mathematic symbol, punctuation or musical notation—or any graphic symbol or glyph.

In addition to English, the keyboard can switch over to Cyrillic, Ancient Greek, Georgian or Arabic, just by changing the language configuration on the computer.

Designers at Art Lebedev Studio have come up with a keyboard called the Optimus. The group hopes to have the final product ready by next year. Similar to the iKeyInfinity device, Optimus can handle non-English characters as well as special symbols, HTML codes and the like. Two versions on the Web site show keyboards specially designed for someone using Adobe Photoshop and another for someone who might be playing *Quake*.

Designers said the keyboard will be OS-

HOT



RSS-Enabled Browsers
What better than getting

news and updates straight into your browser? All major browsers, such as Firefox, Opera and IE7 Beta 1, today integrate multiple RSS feed readers.

RSS Aggregators

Why waste hard disk space on



an RSS Aggregator when you can get the same feeds in your browser? In addition, RSS Aggregators are cluttered and are not easy to use.

independent, and will use organic light-emitting diode (OLED) technology to give it a soft glow. The software development kit will be made available as an open-source code package.

STAMP HERE!

A New 'Fingerprinting' Technique

A low-cost laser scanning system could help in the fight against document and ID fraud, according to its developers at Imperial College in London.

The Laser Surface Authentication (LSA) system scans tiny surface variations of paper, plastic, metal and ceramics to detect the



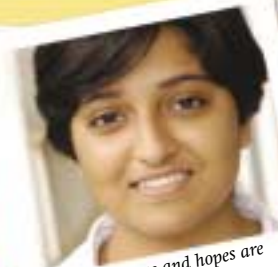
One Silly Question "How long would you like to live if you were a Cyborg?"



"As long as possible, as I am a doctor and I would like to help others"
Bhavik Shah, Gujarat



"I don't really know. Maybe not very long"
Ketaki Likhite, Goa



"Until all my dreams and hopes are fulfilled!"
Roshni Daver, Mumbai



"A hundred years would be enough"
Ninad Kotkar, Mumbai



"I want a short and sweet life within which I can achieve everything"
Priyanka Likhite, Mumbai